"EPICS" IS THE KEY TO CHANGE THE LANDSCAPE OF I-I-S-E CULTURE IN HEI'S IN INDIA



DR. A V RATNA PRASAD,
Principal, Velagapudi Ramakrishna Siddhartha Engineering College, (First Autonomous Institute in A.P.).

EPICS is a course that aims to enhance engineering education by engaging students in real-world projects that address community needs. EPICS not only focuses on community service, but also fosters innovation, incubation, and start-up culture in Higher Education Institutions (HEI) in several ways.

By engaging in community service, students develop a sense of social responsibility and an understanding of the broader impact of their decisions through the application of engineering Skills and Knowledge. They also gain exposure to diverse perspectives and needs, which can inspire them to create innovative solutions for various challenges. Some examples of community service projects include building sustainable infrastructure, designing assistive technologies, or improving energy efficiency. EPICS emphasizes the use of design thinking methodologies to approach problem-solving in a creative and empathetic way. Design thinking helps students to identify the root causes of problems, generate multiple ideas, prototype and test solutions, and iterate based on feedback. These skills are essential for developing new products, services, or business models in start-ups or other ventures.

EPICS projects have the potential to create lasting positive change which can improve the quality of life, increase the availability of resources, foster sustainability, and strengthen community engagement.

HEI's can benefit from integrating EPICS course into their curriculum, as they can foster a culture of innovation, incubation, start-ups, and entrepreneurship among students. These courses also necessitate the setting up of business incubation spaces, access to funding and provide students with the opportunity to develop their entrepreneurial skills and mindset, while also receiving academic support, resources, and mentorship.

V. R. Siddhartha Engineering College has been offering this course as part of the curriculum since 2017 to align with the expected graduate attributes at the completion of the UG Programme, the vision of the honorable Prime Minister for "Make in India" programme and also NEP 2020. This course aims to help the students gain a comprehensive understanding of the society around them and how they can contribute to the community and improve their life.

GOKARAJU RANGARAJU INSTITUTE OF ENGINEERING AND TECHNOLOGY (GRIET)



Gokaraju Rangaraju Institute of Engineering and Technology (GRIET), established in 1997 under the patronage of the Gokaraju Rangaraju Educational Society, is an AICTE approved and permanently affiliated college with UGC Autonomous status under JNTUH, Hyderabad. Following its mission to achieve and impart quality education with an emphasis on practical skills and social relevance, GRIET's endeavor has been to create a conducive teaching learning environment supported by qualified staff from academia and industry, infrastructure and support facilities. It offers nine UG programmes in BTech and six PG programmes in MTech. 06 BTech programmes and 05 PG programmes are accredited by NBA. The institute is accredited by NAAC with 'A++' grade. GRIET is one of the few private engineering colleges to be selected for World Bank's TEQIP -II grant. GRIET is ranked amongst 101-150 rank band in NIRF 2023 released by Ministry of Education, Government of India. GRIET is also ranked as Best Engineering College in Telangana by Times of India, India Today, The Week, the Chronicle, Education World, Competition Success Review and ELETS DL Magazine. GRIET is one of the preferred colleges considering its career achievement record by students in terms of placements, higher education within and outside country and entrepreneurial attempts, publications, research facilities especially in the area of material characterization at high temperature, conduct of national and international conferences, workshop FDPs. ISTE, AP chapter has recognized the college more than once in terms of Best Student, Best Teacher, Best Principal and Best College.

